NPC Complaint Procedure

PART I - Complaint eligibility and requirements

This part concerns who can file or be represented, the official complaint and service forms, documentary proof, prior notice and fee-related requirements. It explains how the published Rules, Citizen's Charter and Complaint-Affidavit relate without deciding anyone's legal status.

01. Reading the complaint-affidavit: persons, information and narrative

The form requests identifying and contact details for complainant and respondent, information about the personal data allegedly processed, prior written contact with the respondent or reasons for non-contact, and relevant incident date, time and place. It has an allegations section and a narrative-of-facts section. Blank form fields are not example case data and should not be populated with imagined personal information.

The March 2026 NPC Complaint-Affidavit has separate spaces for complainant and respondent names, addresses, active email addresses, and contact numbers. These fields explain what the official form collects; the research dataset should not contain completed private complaint examples or real identities. For the RAG prototype, summarize field names and cite the blank government form, rather than embedding actual personal details that may appear in filled-in copies.

The form separates the person making the complaint from the respondent named in the complaint. Its identifying fields support official communication and case documentation; they are not a model for constructing fictional identities in a research corpus. When describing the form to an information-seeking user, it is useful to identify the general categories of information requested without requesting the user's complete contact information in the chatbot itself. The sections concerning processed personal information, incident circumstances and the factual narrative are distinct: a description of what data was affected is not the same as a chronological account of what happened. Readers should obtain the blank official form for its exact field arrangement.

Source references: NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit; PDF pages 2-5); NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit pages 1-4 of 30)

02. Completeness, documentary support and relief requested

The official document is labeled COMPLAINT-AFFIDAVIT / REKLAMONG SALAYSAY, form code NPC_LEO_CID_CAF-V2.0, R0.0, dated 01 March 2026. Its opening reminders call for legible, complete, accurate entries, attachment of supporting evidence, and provision of a valid government-issued ID. The form cautions that defects in form or substance may lead to outright dismissal; it does not determine whether a particular submission will be accepted.

The form provides a space to narrate facts and list evidence attached. It also asks the complainant to identify the relief sought, with form options and free-text space. Explaining the structure of these fields is within scope. Choosing allegations, predicting the outcome, or completing sworn legal content for a user without their own facts is outside scope.

The form's opening reminders place emphasis on legibility, completeness, supporting records and identification. Those reminders relate to document preparation, whereas a decision about sufficiency or admissibility belongs to the NPC under its Rules. Supporting attachments should be identified so the receiving authority can understand what each item is intended to demonstrate. The requested-relief section is another separate part of the complaint: describing a remedy sought does not establish that the facts satisfy the legal standard for granting it. The knowledge base can explain what appears in the blank form but should not choose allegations or remedies for any individual.

Source references: NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit, version V2.0 dated 01 March 2026; PDF page 1); NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit; PDF pages 5-8)

03. Prior contact, sworn declarations and notarization

The current Complaint-Affidavit includes an exhaustion-of-remedies section allowing the complainant to indicate whether the respondent was contacted in writing and to identify correspondence. It also provides for stating a reason when the respondent was not contacted. The evidence portion asks for supporting documents to be listed and properly identified. This is a form description only and does not determine whether any failure to provide prior notice is excused.

The March 2026 form contains a section for the relief sought, including examples of listed selections, followed by verification and certification against forum shopping. Users should follow the current official form and applicable Rules rather than relying on a generated legal document. The form's choices illustrate its structure; they are not a chatbot recommendation to seek damages, an administrative fine, or any particular outcome.

The form contains a Verification and Certification of Non-Forum Shopping and a portion for notarization. This relates to the formal requirements described in Rule II, Section 3. Users should follow the latest official NPC form and seek appropriate assistance for sworn statements; the chatbot must not claim that generated text is already verified or notarized.

These entries concern different aspects of a formal filing: prior attempts to notify the organization, the complainant's requested outcome, and the verification or certification attached to the written submission. They should not be collapsed into a generic instruction to 'fill out the form.' The March 2026 Complaint-Affidavit includes places to document whether the respondent was contacted and whether correspondence exists. It also includes declarations that require the complainant's own knowledge and execution. Explaining where the declarations appear is appropriate; certifying their truth, satisfying notarial formalities or deciding whether a particular omission is excused would be outside the chatbot's role.

Source references: NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit pages 4-7 of 30); NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit pages 7-9 of 30); NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit; PDF pages 8-9)

04. Notarized complaint and physical copies in the 2025 Charter

The 2025 Citizen's Charter filing checklist states that the original copies of the notarized Complaint-Assisted Form and evidence shall be in such number as there are respondents, plus three copies for the file, allocated to CID, GRU, and the complainant. Rule III of the consolidated Rules contains a different formulation for personal submissions. Because these instructions appear in different official contexts, the chatbot should identify the two sources and ask the user to verify the current physical-copy requirement with NPC.

The 2025 Charter's service checklist identifies a notarized Complaints-Assisted Form (CAF) and evidence. For physical paper filing, the checklist uses a formulation based on copies for each respondent plus three file copies (for CID, the records unit, and complainant). This differs in phrasing from the general modes-of-filing rule; verify physical-copy requirements directly with NPC rather than combining the two formulas.

The 2025 Citizen's Charter describes an administrative checklist, including notarized complaint documentation and evidence. It also identifies a physical-copy allocation involving the respondents and copies for specified NPC recipients. Separate provisions of the amended Rules use different wording for personal filing of pleadings and other submissions. The two references should both be preserved, not silently combined into one number. A reliable answer would identify the specific checklist and rule being cited, indicate that the copy-count instructions differ, and recommend checking the current required copies with the NPC before preparing physical duplicates.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed pages 95-96); NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 94 / PDF page 94)

05. Representative identity and authorizations in the service checklist

For transactions through an authorized representative, the 2025 Charter checklist mentions an authorization letter and photocopies of government-issued IDs of the payor and the representative. This operational service checklist does not eliminate any special-power-of-attorney or organizational authorization required under Rule II of the consolidated Rules.

For transactions handled by an authorized representative, the 2025 Citizen's Charter service checklist specifies an authorization letter together with photocopies of government-issued IDs of the payor and representative. This is framed as a document checklist for the filing service. The underlying Rules separately describe formal special-power-of-attorney authority to file on another data subject's behalf. Preserve both points without simplifying them to a single universal ID requirement.

The Citizen's Charter's service checklist asks for authorization and identification documents when someone is acting for another person in the transaction. This administrative instruction is related to, but not identical with, the Rules' provisions on legally authorized complaint representatives. In particular, evidence concerning a person who pays or submits documents should not be confused with the special power of attorney and other legal authority needed to represent a data subject. Answers should distinguish the purpose of each document. The current official checklist remains the appropriate reference for how the agency accepts and processes the service request.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 95 / PDF page 95); NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 96)

06. Service Request and Assessment Form and eligible service clientele

The Service Request and Assessment Form (SRAF) is named in the Charter's complaint service checklist. The Charter indicates A4 paper and back-to-back printing for this form. The SRAF is distinct from the notarized complaint or Complaint-Affidavit, and both appear in the service-submission workflow.

The 2025 NPC Citizen's Charter lists the Complaints and Investigation Division (CID) as the responsible unit for the Filing of Complaints Process. The service classification is Highly Technical, and transaction categories include government-to-citizen, government-to-business, and government-to-government. The Charter's clientele description includes Filipino citizens whose personal data are processed and foreign nationals whose personal data are processed in the Philippines. Detailed legal standing is governed by the amended Rules of Procedure.

The 2025 Citizen's Charter labels the complaint-filing transaction as a government service handled by the Complaints and Investigation Division. It lists Filipino citizens whose personal data is processed and foreign nationals whose personal data is processed in the Philippines among the service clientele. The Service Request and Assessment Form is part of the described administrative processing, and the Charter specifies its paper presentation. Service-client categories explain whom the agency serves; they should not be treated as a substitute for the substantive criteria for filing a complaint in Rule II, Section 1. Both references may be relevant when a user asks whether a complaint can be filed.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 94 / PDF page 94); NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 94 / PDF page 94 (0-based 93))

07. Indigency documentation and fee-related evidence

For an indigent individual, the 2025 Charter provides a more detailed checklist than the 2024 Charter: Barangay or DSWD certification of indigency; notarized financial and property declarations for the litigant and immediate family supported by a disinterested person's notarized affidavit; and a current tax declaration if any. Because this is an affidavit-based requirement, consult the official checklist and the NPC before providing precise filing instructions or declarations.

The Citizen's Charter 2025 lists a Barangay or DSWD certification of indigency from the place of residence. Its checklist also mentions a notarized affidavit concerning income and real property, a supporting notarized affidavit from a disinterested person, and a current Tax Declaration if any. The exact wording is more detailed than the older 2024 Charter. An indigency-related answer should reference the 2025 checklist and distinguish seeking a fee exemption from being automatically approved for it.

Rule II, Section 4 generally conditions further action on payment of appropriate filing fees. It also identifies specified categories that may be exempt, including certain government complainants and indigent complainants, and permits a waiver on motion and good cause at NPC discretion. The provision must be read for exact coverage; not every government-related entity necessarily qualifies. The exact amount is not established by this excerpt and must be checked against the applicable fees schedule.

The 2025 Charter and the amended Rules address different levels of detail concerning possible indigency. The Charter lists documents a person seeking indigent treatment may be asked to provide, while Rule II, Section 4 addresses filing-fee requirements and recognized exceptions or discretion. Neither document by itself authorizes a chatbot to promise that a particular complainant will pay nothing. The description of an indigency affidavit, certification and supporting declaration is useful for orientation, but their accepted form and legal effect should be checked with the NPC. Exact fees and any new exemptions should be verified against the

applicable fee issuance and current agency guidance.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 95 / PDF page 95); NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 96); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 4; PDF page 6)

08. Data subject complaint right and affected-person requirement

The NPC's Data Subject Rights guidance describes the right to file a complaint when a person believes personal information has been misused, wrongfully disclosed or improperly disposed of, or that data privacy rights have been violated. This is general rights information only. It does not establish that the NPC will accept, investigate, or grant any particular case.

Rule II speaks specifically of data subjects affected by an alleged privacy violation or data breach filing complaints under the Data Privacy Act. The Citizen's Charter describes the people who may avail of a government service; the categories in that service description are not a substitute for meeting the Rule's complaint requirements. For chatbot guidance, identify the difference between general service eligibility and the legal requirements for giving a formal complaint due course. Do not pre-judge a person's standing.

Under Rule II, Section 1, a data subject affected by a privacy violation or data breach may file an NPC complaint under the Data Privacy Act. A representative may act for the data subject when authorized through a special power of attorney. The Rule contains specific provisions for minors, persons alleged to be incompetent, juridical representatives, and non-resident citizens. Eligibility under the Rules is not automatically established simply by being listed among the clientele in the Citizen's Charter.

The public data subject rights materials describe the availability of a complaint channel where personal information or privacy rights may have been affected. The amended Rule II, Section 1 frames the formal complainant as an affected data subject, subject to its further provisions on representation and proceedings initiated by the Commission. A useful educational distinction is that an individual may seek general information about a privacy concern even when the facts available to them do not establish eligibility for a formal complaint. The chatbot can point to these provisions and summarize the filing criteria, but it should not make a finding that a particular alleged incident actually violates the Data Privacy Act.

Source references: NPC-RIGHTS (Data Subject Rights webpage; Right to File a Complaint); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 1; PDF page 4)

09. Children and persons alleged to be incompetent

For a minor or person alleged to be incompetent, the applicable Rules of Court provisions apply. Proof of the relationship to the complainant is attached to the complaint. If a parent represents the minor or person, the birth certificate is identified as sufficient relationship evidence. For a guardian, the order appointing that guardian is identified as sufficient proof. The NPC, not the chatbot, determines whether documents satisfy the procedural requirements.

Where a guardian represents a minor or person alleged to be incompetent, Rule II, Section 1 identifies the court order designating that person as guardian as sufficient proof of guardianship. The complaint still remains subject to the other applicable requirements concerning its written form, supporting evidence, prior notice, and any applicable fees. The chatbot may point to the rule and relevant attachment but must not decide whether an individual court order is legally sufficient.

The amended rules allow the pertinent Rules of Court to operate where a minor or person alleged to be incompetent is involved. For a minor represented by a parent, the NPC rule describes a birth certificate as sufficient proof of the relationship. This point concerns proof of authority to represent; it does not mean that merely producing a birth certificate establishes a violation or completes the rest of a complaint's documentary requirements.

Rule II, Section 1 of the consolidated amended Rules specifically discusses a minor or a person alleged to be incompetent. It ties representation to the relevant Rules of Court and identifies proof for a parent or a court-appointed guardian. The form of supporting proof depends on the relationship: the birth certificate is discussed for parental representation, while a court order designating a guardian is discussed for guardianship. These are not merely alternate names for a special power of attorney. A source-grounded answer should preserve the category and proof described in the amended Rule, rather than using an older public webpage's shorter eligibility list as the full statement of current requirements.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 1; PDF page 4)

10. Representative authorization through organizations

One juridical person may represent one or more data subjects if it has special powers of attorney authorizing it to act for them. The individual who acts for the juridical person must additionally be authorized through a board resolution set out in a duly notarized Secretary's Certificate, or the relevant equivalent for government agencies. Refer to the consolidated Rule for exact wording and exceptions.

The amended Rule allows one juridical person to represent one or more data subjects, subject to special powers of attorney for those data subjects. The person who acts for the juridical person must separately have a board-resolution authorization in a duly notarized Secretary's Certificate or the government-agency equivalent. There are two levels of authorization involved. A bare statement that a company represents complainants does not provide enough information to establish compliance.

A representative who files in the name of an affected data subject needs authorization by special power of attorney under Rule II, Section 1. The Rule describes who is acting, on whose behalf, and how authority must be shown. The 2025 Citizen's Charter also lists an authorization letter and identification documents in its service checklist for a representative. These are different source-specific requirements and should not be treated as interchangeable without NPC confirmation.

A single representative may act for a data subject only with the applicable authority described in the amended Rules. When a juridical person represents one or more data subjects, the Rules separately require authorization from the data subjects and authorization for the natural person who appears for that juridical entity. The arrangement is thus not equivalent to an ordinary individual representative acting with a special power of attorney. The particular supporting corporate or governmental authorization is addressed by Rule II, Section 1. Information answers should present these layers carefully and direct readers to the official provision for the exact formal requirements.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 1; PDF page 4)

11. Non-resident citizen complaints and overseas notarization

A non-resident citizen without a Philippine-based authorized representative, or who cannot appoint one, may still submit a complaint under the Rules. The complaint must be notarized by a Philippine embassy or consulate or accompanied by an apostille certificate from the country of origin. This special provision does not resolve all case-specific eligibility questions.

The consolidated 2024 Rules provide a path for a non-resident citizen without a Philippine-based representative, or unable to appoint one, to file a complaint. The complaint must satisfy the rule's formality, including notarization by the Philippine Embassy or Consulate or an apostille certificate from the country of origin. This is a specific non-resident-citizen provision; it should not be expanded automatically to every foreign resident or every overseas document.

The amended Rule provides a pathway for a non-resident citizen who lacks a representative in the Philippines or cannot appoint one. The overseas notarization and apostille language is relevant precisely because the person is outside the country. It should not be generalized into a requirement for every complainant or treated as permission to file informally without the Rule's other requirements. A chatbot answer should identify both the non-resident condition and the authentication alternatives stated in Rule II, Section 1. For any particular country or document, current consular and NPC instructions should be consulted rather than inferred from this summary.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 1; PDF page 4)

12. Required complaint format, facts, evidence and certifications

A sworn certification against forum shopping must accompany the complaint. It addresses whether an action or claim concerning the same issues has been brought or is pending elsewhere; it also deals with subsequent discovery of a same or similar case. The Rule specifies a five-calendar-day reporting requirement after learning of such a filing. Use the original Rule or current NPC form for the precise declaration, not an automatically generated legal attestation.

The Rule requires material facts and supporting documentary or testimonial evidence, if any, showing the alleged act or omission. It separately requires the complaint to identify all reliefs sought. These are different fields: factual narration explains what allegedly happened, while requested relief describes what action the complainant seeks. The NPC, not the chatbot, determines the merits, appropriate relief, and whether the evidence substantiates the claim.

The complaint must narrate material facts of the alleged acts or omissions and include available supporting testimonial or documentary evidence. It identifies relief requested and includes relevant correspondence with the respondent and any action the respondent took. Copies of documentary evidence and applicable witness affidavits are specified as supporting documents. The chatbot can explain what the Rule lists but cannot judge sufficiency of an individual's evidence.

The supporting documents described in Rule II include copies of documentary evidence and witness affidavits, if any. The complaint also carries a sworn certification against forum shopping. The certification addresses other actions or claims involving the same issues and a requirement to report later knowledge of a similar filing within the time set by the Rule. These formalities should be explained as separate from the substance of the alleged privacy incident.

The complaint must be in writing, signed by the complainant or counsel, and verified in the format prescribed by the Rules of Court. The Rule additionally provides required identities, contact information, allegations, available evidence, requested relief, and correspondence. When a user asks for a checklist, the answer should name these core categories together rather than focusing on only the notarized form. Verification is a formal statement, not something the RAG chatbot should sign or generate on someone's behalf.

Rule II, Section 3 treats a complaint as more than a short message of dissatisfaction. The written and verified submission identifies the parties, provides service and contact details, recounts material facts, identifies evidence and any correspondence with the respondent, and states the relief sought. It also includes certification duties concerning related proceedings. These items have different purposes and should remain distinguishable in the knowledge base. In particular, the existence of a form field or an attachment does not establish that the complaint is complete in law. A clear chatbot response can present a checklist of the categories named in the Rule without generating or authenticating a sworn statement for the person asking.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 3(10); PDF page 6); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 3(6)-(7); PDF page 5); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 3(6)-(9); PDF pages 5-6); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 3(9)-(10); PDF page 6); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 3; PDF pages 5-6)

13. Complainant and respondent identification in the Rules

Rule II, Section 3 requires a written, signed, verified complaint. The complaint identifies the affected data subject or injured person as complainant, provides contact/service details (including email if available), and identifies the person, entity, or organization complained of. Where the respondent is not known, the complaint describes circumstances that may lead to identification. The complainant should consult the full Rule for details concerning respondents that are juridical persons.

The amended Rules require identification of the respondent, but acknowledge that the respondent may not be known. In that case the complaint states circumstances that may lead to identification. If the respondent's contact information or address for service is known, the complaint should include it. This is an information-requirement explanation, not an assurance that the NPC will accept a complaint against an unknown person in a specific case.

The Rules require the complainant to identify the individual affected and the person or entity complained of, as far as the relevant information is available. They also contemplate circumstances in which the respondent's identity is not fully known, in which case facts that may lead to identification can be relevant. This differs from simply leaving a name blank without explanation. A form-oriented chatbot should carefully distinguish name and contact fields, underlying factual allegations and any account of how the respondent might be identified. The authority to determine whether an imperfect identification is sufficient remains with the NPC, not with a retrieval model.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 3(1)-(5); PDF page 5); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 3(4)-(5); PDF page 5)

14. Written notification, response period and discretionary waiver

The fifteen-calendar-day period in Rule II, Section 2 is framed by receipt of written information by the PIC, PIP, or concerned entity. The rule concerns whether the entity failed to take timely or appropriate action or failed to respond. The number is not the NPC's own target for final case adjudication. Preserve the event that begins the period (receipt), the responsible recipient (the notified organization), and its role as an exhaustion-of-remedies test.

NPC Rule II, Section 2 provides that the NPC may, in its discretion, waive some or all of the exhaustion-of-remedies requirement for good cause properly alleged and proved, or in serious violation/breach circumstances considering the risk of harm. Illustrative grounds include risk of grave and irreparable damage, lack of a plain, speedy or adequate remedy, or a patently illegal act. Waiver is an NPC decision, not an automatic exemption.

Ordinarily, before an NPC complaint can be given due course, the complainant must show that the personal information controller, processor, or concerned entity was informed in writing about the concern and given an opportunity to act. The Rule refers to no timely appropriate action or no response within fifteen (15) calendar days after the recipient receives written information from the complainant. This is a procedural precondition, not a guarantee of any result.

The Rule allows the NPC to waive some or all exhaustion-of-remedies requirements on stated grounds, including good cause properly alleged and proved or serious-violation circumstances involving harm. Its examples include grave and irreparable damage, lack of an adequate remedy, and a patently illegal act. A chatbot should explain that these are examples described by an official Rule, not a list of automatic exemptions or a finding that the user's incident qualifies.

Rule II, Section 2 sets out an exhaustion-of-remedies requirement connected with informing the personal information controller, processor, or concerned entity of the privacy concern in writing. This supplies that entity with an opportunity to act before the NPC gives a formal complaint due course. A user asking whether they may complain immediately should be shown the normal written-notice rule and the NPC's discretionary waiver provision, rather than an unconditional yes or no.

Rule II, Section 3 requires the complaint to attach correspondence with the respondent concerning the matter complained of and state any action the respondent took. This connects to the written-notice requirement in Rule II, Section 2. The 2026 Complaint-Affidavit form similarly asks whether the respondent was contacted and provides space to identify the correspondence. The chatbot can describe these documents as relevant support without promising that a particular email automatically satisfies the Rule.

Rule II, Section 2 discusses prior written communication to the personal information controller, personal information processor or concerned entity, and the resulting opportunity to take appropriate action. The fifteen-calendar-day reference follows the entity's receipt of the written information; it is not a universal promise that the NPC must resolve a case within fifteen days. The same Rule describes when the NPC may waive some or all of the preliminary requirements, which is a discretionary determination based on the stated conditions. The chatbot should not assume either that prior notice is always unnecessary or that a waiver will be granted. Written correspondence and the respondent's reply, if any, are directly relevant to explaining the documentary context.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 2; PDF pages 4-5); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 2; PDF page 5)

PART 2 - Filing procedure and submission

This part describes practical steps for receiving and submitting complaint paperwork, the channels and document quality requirements, payment and acknowledgement, and contact points. Service steps must be distinguished from the later merits and investigation process.

15. Opening the filing transaction and preparing the SRAF

When the forms and supporting materials are submitted under the Charter workflow, CID receives and acknowledges the SRAF and complaint form, assesses the SRAF, and sends a Link.Biz.Portal link to the client. The associated processing-time column refers to the agency action in the service table. An acknowledgment or administrative assessment must not be equated with a finding that the complaint is sufficient, valid, or likely to succeed.

The 2025 Charter directs a complainant to complete the SRAF and an applicable CAF or Complaint-Affidavit, together with relevant supporting evidence. For the service-submission step, the Charter lists complaints@privacy.gov.ph or in-person submission to CID on the 25th floor of The Upper Class Tower, Quezon Avenue corner Scout Reyes Street, Quezon City 1103. These are practical service channels; the Rules separately identify registered mail and courier as filing modes.

The 2025 Charter's first client step is to accomplish the Service Request and Assessment Form (SRAF) and the relevant complaint or other procedural form. It identifies the Complaint-Assisted Form or Complaint-Affidavit for complaints, while also mentioning application for mediation and motion for reconsideration for distinct transactions. For a first-time complaint inquiry, the chatbot should focus on the complaint documents and not present an application for mediation as mandatory in every new filing.

Under the Charter, the client submits the accomplished SRAF together with copies of the notarized Complaint-Assisted Form or Complaint-Affidavit and relevant supporting evidence. The Charter lists complaints@privacy.gov.ph and in-person submission to the Complaints and Investigation Division. Its processing table describes NPC receipt and acknowledgment, assessment of the SRAF, and sending a payment portal link. This is an administrative filing step, not a decision on the complaint's merits.

The 2025 Charter organizes the service as a sequence beginning with the service request and complaint documents, continuing through receipt and assessment. The SRAF is an administrative service and fee-assessment document, not a substitute for the notarized Complaint-Assisted Form or Complaint-Affidavit and its supporting materials. A user who asks where to begin can be directed to obtain the current forms, review their completeness and follow the filing-channel instructions. Because this is a government service description, the sequence should be attributed to the Charter rather than represented as a list newly invented by the chatbot. The initial receipt and assessment actions are different from determining the legal merits of a case.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed pages 96-97); NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 95 / PDF page 95); NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed pages 95-97)

16. Payment options and the NPC fee issuance

The 2025 Charter allows in-person payment to the NPC cashier at the Quezon City office. In that path the SRAF is endorsed for an order-of-payment process and then to the cashier, after which an official receipt is issued. This procedure is an alternative administrative payment route, not a different substantive complaint category. Users should confirm with NPC whether on-site cashier services are available on their intended visit date.

The Charter includes an online payment path through Land Bank's Link.Biz.Portal, selecting the National Privacy Commission as the merchant. Its service table has a payment stage and a subsequent submission of proof of payment. The fee amount is governed by the applicable NPC schedule and is not established merely by the portal's existence; avoid inventing a price or assuring that a particular person is not required to pay.

The Charter describes an NPC fees/charges step after assessment. It refers to the Land Bank Link.Biz.Portal for online payment and permits in-person payment through the NPC cashier. The Charter points to NPC Circular No. 2023-01 on the Schedule of Fees and Charges rather than setting out a universal fixed complaint fee in this section. Do not infer a fee amount; ask users to confirm the current official assessment, any exemption, and payment instructions before paying.

The 2025 Charter mentions both online payment through the designated Link.Biz.Portal procedure and payment through the NPC cashier. It ties the fee requirement to the NPC's schedule of fees and charges rather than giving the research corpus authority to set an amount. The applicant's payment path may depend on instructions provided after the SRAF is assessed. Therefore, an answer should avoid directing the person to transfer a guessed amount or treating an unofficial payment link as trustworthy. The correct sequence, merchant identity and current payment details should be confirmed using the official source and NPC contact details.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 97); NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed pages 96-97); NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed pages 95-96 / PDF pages 95-96)

17. Submitting documents at the Quezon City location

The 2025 Citizen's Charter directs in-person filers to the Complaints and Investigation Division at the 25th Floor of The Upper Class Tower, Quezon Avenue corner Scout Reyes Street, Quezon City 1103. The NPC contact webpage also identifies The Upper Class Tower in Quezon City. Older Pasay City details appear in archived documents and should not be mixed into current answer passages. Users should verify the office and hours before arriving.

The NPC currently lists its address as the 25th-27th floors of The Upper Class Tower, Quezon Avenue corner Scout Reyes Street, Quezon City, Philippines. The 2025 Charter refers specifically to the CID filing service on the 25th floor. Older NPC documents printed with a PICC/Pasay City office header reflect historical office details and should not be used as current directions.

The 2025 Charter's complaint-filing service and the public NPC contact page identify the agency's Quezon City office at The Upper Class Tower, Quezon Avenue corner Scout Reyes Street. This supersedes the physical destination shown in the 2024 Charter excerpt preserved in the earlier working corpus. The address of the agency and the specific receiving office or floor should both be read from the up-to-date publication. A chatbot can give the verified location as published and provide the official contact page, but it should not guarantee that a particular counter will be open or that walk-in requirements have not changed on the day of a visit.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 96); NPC-CONTACT-LIVE (NPC contactus webpage; Contact Us)

18. Public webpage overviews and Tagalog support

The 2025 Charter includes a Handling of Privacy Concerns Process that is distinct from the Filing of Complaints Process. The former includes ways to seek assistance or ask privacy questions through CID, while the latter sets out complaint-form, supporting-document, payment, and docketing steps. The chatbot should first clarify whether the user wants information about a concern or the formal filing procedure before giving a checklist.

Ang opisyal na pahina ng NPC na "File a Complaint" ay may seksiyong Tagalog tungkol sa mga maaaring magsampa ng reklamo at sa mga paraang maaaring gamitin sa paghahain (personal, registered mail, courier, at email kung pinahihintulutan). Para sa eksaktong requirements at exemptions, sundin ang mas bagong amended Rules at Citizen's Charter; huwag ituring ang mas lumang paliwanag sa webpage bilang kapalit ng mga iyon.

The NPC's public File a Complaint webpage presents practical guidance on who may complain, filing channels and an initial-response estimate. It names in-person submission, registered mail, courier and Commission-authorized email. It still frames some eligibility details as the 2021 Rules; therefore the consolidated 2024-amended Rules, not any older simplified webpage wording, are preferred for formal eligibility, exceptions and procedural interpretation.

The NPC provides public guidance in English and Tagalog on its complaint pages. The webpages can be useful for plain-language orientation, while the amended Rules and the more recent Charter are better sources when a specific legal or service detail is disputed. An inquiry about a general privacy concern is not automatically a formally lodged complaint; the Charter separately describes handling privacy concerns. These distinctions help the chatbot remain useful without suggesting that sending a general message completes the filing requirements. A user who prefers Filipino may be pointed to the official Tagalog guidance, while legal citations can continue to identify the controlling provision in English.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Handling of Privacy Concerns Process; printed pages 93-94); NPC-FILING-WEB (File a Complaint webpage; Tagalog Version); NPC-FILING-WEB (File a Complaint webpage; English Version)

19. Receipt, assessment, payment validation and docketing

The Charter instructs clients to send proof of payment to assigned NPC email channels, including complaints@privacy.gov.ph, asd.cashier@privacy.gov.ph, and fpmd@privacy.gov.ph as indicated for the transaction. It describes NPC validation, assignment of a docket number, and returning a document showing the docket number and official receipt by email or in person. Do not treat issuance of a docket number as a judgment on the complaint.

The Charter's step after payment asks the client to send proof to assigned NPC email addresses and lists complaints@privacy.gov.ph, asd.cashier@privacy.gov.ph, and fpmd@privacy.gov.ph. The agency receives, acknowledges, forwards, and validates proof, then communicates confirmation to the CID. The chatbot should not tell users to disclose sensitive bank credentials or upload private proof of payment to the chatbot itself; it should direct users to current NPC instructions.

As a later client step, the 2025 filing service provides for receiving a document copy bearing the docket number and the Official Receipt, either by email or in person. This follows prior intake, fee-related tasks, and docket assignment in the Charter table. For RAG answers, explain what the applicant is meant to receive

without claiming that receipt of a docketed copy resolves the case or guarantees a future ruling.

The Charter describes NPC personnel validating proof of payment and then assigning or stamping a docket number on the document filed. These are steps of the documented service workflow. The presence of a docket number indicates an administrative case reference, not a judgment that a DPA violation occurred. The relevant recipient may obtain a returned copy bearing the docket number along with the official receipt.

The 2025 service matrix separates the client's submission and payment tasks from the agency's acknowledgement, checking, proof-of-payment validation and assignment of a docket number. A document with a docket number and an official receipt shows steps in the administrative intake process; it is not equivalent to an adjudicative decision or acceptance of all legal allegations. The Charter identifies official email addresses involved in sending proof of payment and in returning documentary confirmations. A chatbot should communicate these steps in order, with clear attribution, and avoid treating an unverified screenshot, informal message or generated receipt as proof that the NPC recorded a case.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 96 / PDF page 96); NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 97)

20. One-hour service estimate and physical-copy conflict

The Charter shows a total of one hour for the filing-of-complaints service process, and its table enumerates short agency-handling steps. This is not a promise that complaint investigation, mediation, adjudication, or final decision will be completed in an hour. The chatbot must explicitly identify this as a service-processing estimate and separate it from legal time periods in the Rules of Procedure.

The 2025 Citizen's Charter complaint checklist and the amended Rule III personal-filing provision describe their physical copy counts differently. Because the sources have different purposes and formulations, the RAG system must not silently select one and omit the other. Instead, describe the Charter service checklist and the Rule, cite both, and recommend confirming the applicable number of originals and respondent copies with the NPC CID.

The Charter's total of approximately one hour covers the listed administrative filing service activities in its process matrix. It cannot be used to answer how long an investigation, mediation or final decision will take. There is also a distinct issue with physical copies: the Charter's service checklist and the amended Rules' personal-filing provision describe quantities differently. A reliable RAG answer ought to surface the relevant source titles and wording instead of averaging the numbers or choosing one without context. The prudent practical guidance is to verify the current physical-copy requirement with NPC before printing and submitting documents.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed pages 95-97)

21. Complaint channels, phone lines and general inquiries

The official contact page separates complaint-related contact information from general inquiries, advisory opinions, and regulatory registration or compliance channels. An information-seeking user may be directed to the general contact route, but actual complaint-filing instructions should be tied to the current CID filing page or Charter procedure. This distinction reduces the risk of a chatbot telling someone that sending an informal question necessarily files a formal complaint.

For complaint-related assistance, the NPC contact page lists complaints@privacy.gov.ph, main telephone (+63) 2 5322 1322 with local 114 or 115, and complaints mobile numbers +63 970 818 0555 (Smart) and +63 905 506 1478 (Globe). The page indicates Monday-Friday, 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM for the main contact line. Contact details can change, so check the official live page before real-world use.

The NPC website provides separate contact options for general inquiries and for complaints. The complaints channel is complaints@privacy.gov.ph; the main NPC contact page supplies a general inquiries channel as well. A request for information is not necessarily a formally filed complaint. For uncertain questions, refer to the contact page rather than making a case-status claim.

The official contact page lists the NPC main telephone number (+63) 2 5322 1322, weekday contact hours 08:00 to 17:00, and dedicated complaint local numbers 114 or 115, with mobile numbers for Smart and Globe. These details are time-sensitive and may be changed by the NPC. The chatbot should treat the contact page as the preferred live reference instead of older footer phone numbers or locations appearing in historical rules PDFs.

The NPC contact page separates complaint contacts from general inquiries and other functions. The existence of a public hotline, general information mailbox or inquiry channel does not by itself mean a formal complaint has been filed. When the user wants instructions for submitting a verified complaint, the chatbot should refer to the published complaint channel and the relevant filing form, not only a general contact address. Office hours and numbers can change, so the official contact page should be given as the current reference. If a retrieved passage contains conflicting channel details, the system should make that conflict visible rather than silently selecting one.

Source references: NPC-CONTACT-LIVE (Contact Us page; checked 2026-10-19); NPC-CONTACT-LIVE (NPC contactus webpage; For Complaints); NPC-CONTACT-LIVE (NPC contactus webpage; For General Inquiries)

22. Electronic documents and older website technical guidance

The NPC webpage explains that electronic documents should be digitally signed, be in PDF format where practicable, and use compliant page sizes. It notes the possible costs of printing submissions. These are statements from the public guidance webpage and should be cross-checked with Rule III and current NPC filing instructions for each case. An uploaded PDF does not become acceptable solely because its file extension is .pdf.

The NPC webpage discusses CDs, thumb drives, and similar portable electronic storage devices, including provision of counterpart devices to opposing parties and risks associated with malware. This webpage text gives additional practical background about how evidence may be delivered in a specific form. The chatbot should not recommend portable media as the best or currently required submission path without checking current NPC reception and technical requirements.

The NPC's public filing webpage lists personal filing, registered mail, courier, and email authorized by the Commission as ways to send a verified complaint or notarized complaint-assisted form with supporting material. It provides accessible English and Tagalog explanations. Because the webpage describes the 2021 Rules at a high level, it should be used as supplementary guidance and not to override subsequently amended legal provisions or the newer 2025 service checklist.

The NPC's public filing webpage describes electronic transmission as a conditional filing route and discusses details such as PDF presentation, signatures and portable electronic storage devices. Because the page references the 2021 procedure and may lag later amendments or operational changes, its technical

instructions should be interpreted together with the amended Rules and current Charter. A portable drive or digital attachment is not interchangeable with every form of formally filed paper document. Readability, completeness and the mode currently accepted by NPC matter. The corpus should not tell users to send sensitive records to an unverified email address or upload them to a third-party site.

Source references: NPC-FILING-WEB (Filing a Complaint page; electronic submissions); NPC-FILING-WEB (Filing a Complaint page; portable media); NPC-FILING-WEB (Filing a Complaint page; English and Tagalog sections)

23. Modes of filing and electronic submission limits

Email transmission may serve as a filing mode when authorized by the Commission under Rule III. Where electronic filing is permitted, the Rule connects the filing date to the electronic-transmission date provided the filing is sufficient in form. A PDF or email sent to an NPC address should not be described as automatically filed regardless of its contents. The chatbot should cite the rule's conditions and the current service instructions for applicable email channels.

Rule III, Section 1 provides modes for pleadings and submissions: personal filing, registered mail, courier, and electronic mail when the Commission authorizes it. For personal filing, the Rule states two original copies plus copies for receiving parties. The Citizen's Charter presents a service checklist with a different copy-count formulation for complaint processing; treat these as source-specific instructions and confirm the applicable physical-copy requirement with NPC before filing.

In Rule III, email filing is conditional on Commission authorization and sufficiency of the submission's form. Illegible, erroneous, or malfunctioning electronic submissions will not be considered. The NPC may require conventionally served printouts or original signed documents in appropriate circumstances. Do not promise that any emailed file is automatically accepted.

Rule III distinguishes submitting pleadings personally, using registered mail, using a courier and transmitting electronically when the Commission authorizes that mode. The Rule also discusses how the filing date is recognized and imposes a sufficiency condition for an electronically transmitted submission. These differences are operationally significant: giving a document to a courier and sending it by email are not necessarily treated identically for filing-date purposes. The chatbot should identify the selected mode, then cite the specific Rule III language. It should never guarantee that a message sent to an arbitrary address counts as valid filing, or that a malformed electronic document will be accepted.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule III, Section 1; PDF pages 6-7); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule III, Sections 1-2; PDF page 7)

24. Registered mail, courier and evidence of dispatch

Courier filing is listed in Rule III alongside personal filing, registered mail, and authorized electronic mail. The rules connect mailed or couriered submissions to proof of dispatch and case-record handling. The NPC Filing a Complaint webpage also lists courier among available submission modes. The chatbot should distinguish the legal filing method from a specific vendor, delivery guarantee, or current reception address, which may change over time.

The Rules list registered mail as a mode of filing pleadings and other submissions. The post office stamp on the envelope or the registry receipt is described as evidence of the mailing date for the purposes specified by the Rule, and the envelope forms part of the case record. This does not mean that a user can assume the package was complete or accepted. The original Rule should be consulted when timing is consequential.

The amended Rules recognize registered mail and accredited courier service in addition to personal filing. The provisions about mailing dates and documentary proof are relevant when someone asks how the date of filing is established. Such proof is also separate from the content requirements of the complaint itself: a correctly mailed document may still be reviewed for sufficiency, identification and supporting records. Answers should avoid declaring a deadline satisfied for a specific user without their actual evidence of dispatch and without checking the applicable Rule. The appropriate advice is to preserve official sending and receiving records and consult the exact current filing rule.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule III, Section 1; PDF pages 6-7)

25. Personal filing, serving other parties and document usability

The Rules allow filing pleadings and other submissions personally at the NPC. They specify copies for personal filing and that the receiving NPC officer or employee indicates the date and hour of filing on the submission. The 2025 service checklist may prescribe a different copy calculation for its process. For practical guidance, report the source-specific requirements and avoid treating the chatbot's advice as an official acceptance or filing timestamp.

The Commission can, in circumstances contemplated by Rule III, ask for printed or original signed copies of materials initially filed or served electronically. The Rule also provides for conventional submission of object evidence and other documents not readily amenable to electronic scanning. The RAG corpus should not imply that all evidence can always be supplied as scanned images or that mixed electronic and conventional service is always permissible.

Rule III separately discusses serving documents on other parties and filing them with the NPC. Electronic service by one party to another is limited to circumstances in which the recipient consents or the Commission orders that mode. Other pleadings and submissions, apart from the complaint, have an affidavit-of-service requirement under Section 1. A chatbot response should not treat sending a document to NPC as conclusive proof that it was properly served on every other party.

The amended Rules state that illegible, erroneous, or otherwise malfunctioning email submissions are not considered by the NPC. Electronic documents may also be subject to orders requiring printed originals or conventional service, according to the Rule. A filing checklist should therefore emphasize readable attachments and the need to comply with NPC's current instructions, while avoiding any claim that a chatbot has checked authenticity, signatures, technical validity, or receipt.

Rule III deals with both filing a document with the NPC and serving relevant submissions on other parties. These are different procedural acts, and one cannot always be assumed from the other. The Rule also addresses physical submission and electronic documents that are illegible, erroneous or otherwise not usable. A person's own electronic copy may be readable on their device but still fail official technical requirements. The 2025 Charter is a separate service checklist for submitting the complaint package. Where the rule and checklist differ on physical copies or other practical details, cite them separately and encourage confirmation through the current official complaint channel.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule III, Section 1; PDF pages 6-7); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule III, Section 2; PDF page 7); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule III, Sections 1-2; PDF page 7)

26. Where a complaint may be filed and assignment to an officer

Under Rule II, Section 5, filing is permitted at any NPC office. Section 6 provides for an NPC case to be raffled or assigned to an Investigating Officer within five calendar days of receipt. This case-assignment step does not mean the complaint has been decided or that all issues have been resolved.

Rule II, Section 5 says a complaint may be filed at any NPC office. The 2025 Citizen's Charter describes the CID service at The Upper Class Tower in Quezon City, while the contact webpage identifies the agency's present Quezon City office location. This part of the corpus keeps the legal statement about NPC offices separate from the current service-delivery address. Users should confirm operating hours and submission arrangements directly before a physical visit.

Rule II provides a general statement about where a complaint may be filed and a five-calendar-day reference for raffle or assignment after receipt. The 2025 Charter, meanwhile, identifies a specific practical service location and submission channels for its complaint-filing transaction. Thus, a procedural answer may properly use the Rules for the legal filing principle and the Charter for the administrative point of contact. The assignment period is not a guarantee of a final result or a promise that every procedural defect has been resolved. A question about how far an individual case has progressed should be referred to the NPC rather than answered speculatively.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Sections 5-6; PDF page 6); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 5; PDF page 6)

PART 3 - Processing, data subject rights and supporting guidance

This part supplies procedural context for early assessment, possible dismissal, conferences, mediation and wider data subject rights. It highlights limits on what can be inferred from a public reference corpus when case-specific records are unavailable.

27. Why the 2024 amended Rules matter to this corpus

The NPC publicly announced Circular No. 2024-01, dated 26 January 2024, with amendments taking effect 10 February 2024. The announcement identifies changes affecting complaint eligibility, electronic service, party joinder, and mediation. For precise requirements, use the amended consolidated Rules rather than treating the news announcement as a primary legal text.

The NPC's announcement of its 2024-01 amendments explains that the revisions clarified who can file, recognized additional electronic methods for service, made arrangements for related parties, and updated mediation. It provides historical context for why older complaint guides may differ from the consolidated 2024 Rules. When the wording of a general explanatory webpage conflicts with the amended consolidated legal text, the latter is the proper rule reference.

NPC Circular No. 2024-01 introduced changes to the 2021 Rules, and the agency announced that the amendments would take effect in February 2024. The consolidated document titled '2021 Rules of Procedure of the National Privacy Commission, as Amended' is therefore the preferred reference for the amended procedural text discussed in this dataset. Public webpage summaries may still present simplified descriptions or older wording. A properly grounded RAG response should resolve that hierarchy by citing the relevant consolidated Rule provision, while using the webpages for plain-language context where not inconsistent. The version of a law or procedure is part of the data, not a detail to hide.

Source references: NPC-ANNOUNCE-2024 (NPC amendment announcement, 30 Jan 2024); NPC-ANNOUNCE-2024 (NPC announcement of Circular 2024-01)

28. Form allegations, evidence and question-and-answer attachment

The form separates the type of alleged personal data violation, the date/time/place of the incident, a chronological narration of facts, and a listing of evidence attached. These fields invite factual description from a complainant. A chatbot may point users to where the form asks for each kind of information, but should not fill in unprovided dates,

identify accused parties, or turn a narrative into a finding that a crime was committed.

The remaining pages contain detailed question-and-answer prompts about various alleged privacy offenses. They are a form designed to collect allegations and supporting facts, not a universal questionnaire to determine guilt. The Version 5 retrieval corpus intentionally does not reproduce the blank response lines or offense-elements interview pages, because the chatbot's research scope is complaint filing procedure, not legal classification of incidents.

The 2026 Complaint-Affidavit contains an attached question-and-answer section organized around different alleged Data Privacy Act violations. Its prompts are intended to help a person set out facts for the official form. These prompts should not be turned into a legal diagnosis engine, and the chatbot should not select offense elements or direct a person toward a particular theory. The research corpus retains high-level form

navigation rather than replicating many blank response lines.

The 2026 Complaint-Affidavit includes blank fields and an attached question-and-answer document about kinds of data privacy allegations. These questions can help the reader understand what information the official form requests, but they do not tell a chatbot which accusation is appropriate in a particular person's circumstances. Nor should every checkbox or sample allegation be treated as a judicially proven fact. The data corpus uses the blank government document for form structure, reminders and evidence categories only. It avoids filling the form with imaginary case histories or reproducing long runs of underline characters that would pollute retrieval results without adding substantive information.

Source references: NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit pages 4-7 of 30); NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit; PDF pages 10-30); NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit pages 10-30 of 30)

29. Privacy notice, collection and retention in the complaint form

The March 2026 complaint form includes a privacy notice identifying categories such as name, address, email, contact number, and identification details collected when a complaint is submitted. It describes use for documentation and processing and, where appropriate, referral to another government agency. This corpus includes the notice as context without collecting any completed form fields. The RAG chatbot itself should avoid asking users to upload actual complaint documents containing sensitive personal data.

The form states that only authorized NPC personnel may access the personal information covered by its notice, and discusses exchanges through electronic mail or hard copy and retention as long as necessary for its purpose. These statements describe the NPC's form notice; they are not a promise about the security practices of a student-built chatbot. A prototype using public documents should not represent itself as an official secure NPC submission system.

The March 2026 form contains an agency privacy notice because a real complaint may involve names, addresses, identity documents and other personal data. That notice helps explain why a complaint filed with the NPC is a formal administrative transaction involving information held for a stated purpose. The RAG experiment described in the project's proposal is different: it uses publicly available procedural documents, not private complainant files. Researchers should avoid including filled-out complaint forms,

identity numbers or records of real cases in the dataset. If a user volunteers sensitive facts to the chatbot, the response should remain within the public information scope rather than acting like an NPC case intake system.

Source references: NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit pages 1-2 of 30)

30. Legibility reminders and the meaning of filing-service time

The current NPC Complaint-Affidavit warns that a complaint insufficient in form and substance may be dismissed. It asks applicants to write legibly, complete the form accurately, attach evidence, and provide a valid government-issued identity document. These reminders describe what the source form says; they do not let the chatbot certify that a user's papers are legally complete or advise that any particular allegation necessarily supports liability.

The 2025 Charter gives a total service-processing time of one hour for the listed filing/fee/docketing workflow. That service transaction time is not a timeline for complaint investigation, mediation, or final adjudication. The amended Rules contain separate periods for procedural stages.

The reminder to complete the official form carefully and attach evidence concerns the substance and readability of an actual submission. The Charter's administrative time estimate concerns the handling of an intake service. These are separate questions, although both may arise when a person asks whether their complaint is ready. The chatbot may explain that an incomplete form can create procedural problems and that a listed service transaction has an estimated duration, without certifying a submission as sufficient or predicting the length of an investigation. The actual reviewer and the formal NPC process determine
case-specific outcomes.

Source references: NPC-CAF-2026 (Complaint-Affidavit page 1 of 30); NPC-CC-2025 (Filing of Complaints Process; printed page 96 / PDF page 96)

31. Public assistance and privacy concerns before a formal filing

The 2025 Charter describes a separate handling-of-privacy-concerns service that includes in-person, email, and telephone channels. A user who is unsure which complaint materials to prepare may initially seek official guidance through those published contact methods. The existence of an assistance process does not remove filing requirements, and asking a question through an inquiry channel should not be represented as equivalent to submitting a verified complaint.

The 2025 Charter also describes a separate CID service for handling privacy concerns and inquiries, including email and phone assistance. Sending an inquiry or requesting guidance should not automatically be represented as successfully filing a formal complaint. People uncertain how to proceed may contact the NPC Complaints and Investigation Division for guidance on which process applies.

The 2025 Charter includes a service for handling privacy concerns as well as a separate complaint-filing service. This matters for people who primarily need clarification about a possible privacy problem, since seeking guidance and lodging a formal verified complaint do not have identical requirements or effects. A knowledge-base answer can indicate that the NPC offers informational assistance and identify the distinction from the service request, complaint documents, fees and docketing used for formal filing. It should not claim that an inquiry channel has converted a concern into a formal case unless that transition is established by an official NPC record.

Source references: NPC-CC-2025 (Citizen Charter; Handling of Privacy Concerns Process; printed pages 93-94); NPC-CC-2025 (Handling of Privacy Concerns Process; printed pages 92-94

/ PDF pages 92-94)

32. Handling outdated response descriptions and unresolved conflicts

If the retrieved corpus does not establish a current fee, a special exemption, whether an email submission was accepted, or whether a particular document is legally sufficient, the chatbot should clearly say that the information is not established. It can direct the user to the official NPC contact page and complaint-related lines. This answer-handling rule prevents the prototype from inventing procedural guarantees or choosing silently among conflicting source instructions.

The public complaint webpage describes a thirty-calendar-day period for an initial action on a received complaint. The consolidated amended Rule IV similarly concerns giving due course or dismissing without prejudice in the pre-investigation phase. The webpage also presents a broad duration estimate for later proceedings, but that estimate must not be treated as a guaranteed deadline or as a more authoritative rule than the amended consolidated text.

A public webpage's estimate of when a response may be expected should be checked against the consolidated procedural rules governing initial review. Questions about 'how long' require careful identification of which stage is meant: acknowledging an inquiry, receiving documents, assigning an officer, giving a complaint due course, mediation and final adjudication are not interchangeable. When sources are from different dates or speak about different steps, the chatbot should explain those differences. If the available documents fail to establish a reliable answer, it should say so and direct the user to the official complaint contact page instead of manufacturing a universal completion date.

Source references: NPC-CONTACT-LIVE (Contact Us page; checked 2026-10-19); NPC-FILING-WEB (Filing a Complaint webpage; response-time section)

33. Data subject rights in context

The NPC rights page defines a data subject in accessible terms as someone whose personal data is collected, stored, or processed, and identifies personal information controllers and processors as organizations responsible for respecting data privacy rights. These terms help users understand whom an initial concern may involve. The informational definitions do not tell the chatbot to decide legal responsibility or give individualized legal conclusions about a business or individual.

The NPC Data Subject Rights page presents the right to file a complaint alongside the rights to be informed, access, object, rectify, erase or block data, portability, and damages. This rights overview supplies general context for a user deciding where to obtain official information. It does not establish that a particular violation occurred or that a requested remedy will be granted. Formal complaint procedure requirements are supplied by the amended Rules and complaint forms.

The NPC rights guidance discusses transmissibility and the ability of a legal assignee, lawful heir, parent, or guardian to assert rights in situations described by law. The same page mentions a Special Power of Attorney for a living adult wishing to authorize another person. Formal complaint representation remains governed by the amended Rule II provisions. The chatbot should cite the rights page as supporting context, not treat every general rights example as a filing exemption.

The NPC's public educational materials list several data subject rights and situate the ability to file a complaint within the broader framework of personal data protection. The broad rights overview is useful context, but a chatbot whose research scope is complaint

procedure should resist wandering into individualized legal interpretation of every right or every data-processing practice. People may also ask whether another individual can assert a person's rights; such questions require careful source-specific explanations rather than a blanket assumption of authority. For formal complaint representation, the amended Rule II provisions remain essential and should take precedence over casual paraphrases of the rights webpage.

Source references: NPC-RIGHTS (Data Subject Rights landing page; general introductory section); NPC-RIGHTS (Data Subject Rights landing page; rights menu); NPC-RIGHTS (Data Subject Rights landing page; transmissibility)

34. Amending a complaint and joining related parties

The amended Rule IV includes provisions for amendments of a complaint and joinder of parties. A complainant may substantially amend once before the respondent comments; later substantial amendments need the Investigating Officer's leave after a motion. Multiple complainants or respondents may be joined in a single case where the Rule's related-transaction and common-issue conditions apply. Actual rulings belong to the NPC.

The amended Rules address the possibility of joining parties with related claims, the need for indispensable parties, and the treatment of omitted necessary parties. They also address misjoinder and non-joinder. These provisions show that an NPC complaint does not always involve precisely one complainant against precisely one respondent. Whether consolidation or joinder applies to a real filing is a determination for the NPC, and chatbot guidance should remain descriptive.

Rule IV allows a complainant to substantially amend a complaint once as a matter of right before the respondent files a comment. The respondent then receives a copy and a fresh period to comment. After the respondent comments, a substantial amendment calls for a motion and leave from the Investigating Officer. This is procedural background only; the chatbot should not decide what an individual should amend or draft litigation strategy.

The amended Rules discuss substantial amendments to a complaint and procedural joinder when a dispute involves parties or facts that are related in the ways defined by the Rule. A key difference is that amending an existing complaint and adding parties are not the same act. The Rule also distinguishes the stage before a respondent has filed a comment from later stages. The chatbot may explain the structure of these provisions and point the reader to the cited rule sections, but it should not advise a litigant to amend pleadings or declare that a particular proposed combination of claims will be accepted.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule IV, Sections 2-4; PDF page 9); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule IV, Sections 3-8; PDF page 9); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule IV, Section 2; PDF page 9)

35. Contact updates, confidentiality and service of NPC issuances

The amended Rules address changes in a party's physical or electronic-mail address while a complaint is pending. They require notice of the change to the NPC and other parties within five calendar days of the change. Communications sent to the address of record are presumed valid unless NPC receives the notice. This is relevant to staying reachable during a case but is different from how a first-time complaint is submitted.

Rule V contains obligations concerning confidentiality of information obtained through discovery during proceedings. The Rule limits use of discovered information to legal purposes and the NPC's mandate, including when it is not presented at a hearing. The RAG dataset should not include confidential case records, actual submitted evidence, or

complainant personal information. The prototype's corpus is limited to public procedural guidance, not live complaint-case documents.

The consolidated Rules permit the NPC, at its discretion, to serve judgments, orders, or resolutions personally, by registered mail, by courier, through approved electronic systems, or by email. They also describe when electronic service is treated as complete. A user should monitor officially provided contact channels, but the chatbot should not certify that a specific legal notice was served or infer the running of an individual's deadlines without the actual notice.

The Rules discuss the handling of official communications and certain safeguards in proceedings. Address changes can affect where messages are sent, and service of an NPC decision or order is governed by formal rules rather than informal assumptions about whether someone has read an email. Confidentiality of information exchanged during procedural steps also has a distinct legal purpose. The dataset does not contain those exchanged private materials, and the project should not try to infer them. A chatbot answer should distinguish what the published procedure says about communications from anything requiring access to the private case file or proof of actual service in an individual case.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule IV, Section 11; PDF page 10); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule V, Section 6; PDF page 13); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule III, Section 6; PDF page 8)

36. The pre-investigation review and possible dismissal grounds

The amended Rules identify deficiencies in form or noncompliance with the written complaint requirements as possible grounds for outright dismissal without prejudice in the preliminary phase. The failure to give the respondent an opportunity to address the complaint, absent justification, is another listed ground. A chatbot can identify these issues and relevant sources but cannot determine whether a particular omission will lead to dismissal or whether good cause exists.

Other grounds described in Rule IV include a matter that does not concern a Data Privacy Act violation, privacy violation, or data breach, insufficient information substantiating allegations, and inability to identify or trace the parties despite diligence, with stated qualifications. These explain why a properly presented concern might still not be given due course. Avoid interpreting this list as a prediction that any identifiable complainant will win or lose.

The amended Rule IV, Section 1 concerns the initial pre-investigation phase. Within thirty calendar days from receipt, an Investigating Officer may give a complaint due course or dismiss it without prejudice on specified grounds. These grounds include inadequate form, insufficient supporting information, lack of an opportunity for the respondent to respond without justification, a matter outside the relevant privacy concern, or parties who cannot be identified or traced. The thirty days is not a guaranteed time to complete final adjudication.

The amended Rule IV describes an initial pre-investigation phase. Within thirty calendar days after receipt, the Investigating Officer may give a complaint due course or dismiss it without prejudice on identified grounds.
This refers to the preliminary treatment of a filed complaint; it should not be confused with the 2025 Charter's one-hour filing-service processing time or with the total duration of adjudication.

Rule IV describes an initial examination under which the Investigating Officer may give the complaint due course or dismiss it without prejudice on specified grounds within the stated thirty-calendar-day framework. Among the described concerns are formal defects, insufficient preliminary contact with the respondent, alleged facts outside the DPA or

personal data breach scope, insufficient information supporting the allegations, and identification problems. The Rule describes possible grounds; it does not authorize the chatbot to announce that an actual complaint must be dismissed. A trustworthy answer should identify the initial procedural stage and cite Rule IV, Section 1 without confusing it with the eventual outcome after investigation and adjudication.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule IV, Section 1(1)-(2); PDF page 8); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule IV, Section 1(3)-(5); PDF page 8); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule IV, Section 1; PDF page 8); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule IV, Section 1; PDF pages 8-9)

37. Case assignment and opportunity for a respondent comment

Rule II, Section 6 instructs the NPC to raffle or assign the case to an Investigating Officer within five calendar days from receipt. This interval concerns assignment of responsibility for proceedings. It must not be described as the time required for NPC to provide an outcome, to rule on every allegation, or to compensate a complainant. Other procedural periods and the completeness of submissions may be relevant later.

When a complaint is given due course under Rule IV, the respondent is required to file a verified comment within fifteen calendar days after receiving the order. A copy of the complaint and supporting evidence

accompanies the order to comment. The rule also specifies a consequence for a missed comment period. This period belongs to the respondent's procedural response, not to the prior written-notice period before the complaint is filed.

The initial assignment period in Rule II and the procedural window for a respondent to comment in Rule IV govern different actors and stages. The first concerns what the Commission does after receipt of a complaint; the second concerns the respondent's participation in the procedural process. They should not be added together as a guaranteed case-resolution schedule, nor should a chatbot treat them as deadlines that apply to every possible situation without qualifications. A passage retrieved for a time-related question should include the name of the applicable rule, the stage involved and the reference point for counting any days.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule II, Section 6; PDF page 6); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule IV, Section 9; PDF page 10)

38. Mediation applications, fees and distinct timelines

The Rules provide that an Application for Mediation must be jointly filed, with stated authority for representatives, and that mediation fees generally apply unless an applicable exemption is established. The application is not automatically approved merely because parties express interest. Any answer about exact fee amounts should refer to the applicable NPC issuance and not invent a figure; exemptions are governed by the separate legal rules and NPC discretion.

Rule VI describes mediation as a possible means of exploring settlement. Parties may, by mutual agreement and within the procedural window identified in the Rule, express their interest in mediation. A joint Application for Mediation is described, including requirements concerning authorized representatives. This is a background explanation for a chatbot; it must not pressure a complainant to settle or predict the effectiveness of mediation in their case.

The Rules allow an order to mediate to suspend complaint proceedings for up to ninety calendar days while mediation proceeds. A later provision describes an initial sixty-day mediation period with a possible thirty-day extension for good cause, within the stated maximum. These are mediation-specific periods, not a promise of an overall complaint completion date. The 2025 Citizen's Charter one-hour estimate relates only to the filing service.

The amended Rules include mediation provisions that are separate from initial complaint

filing. A mediation process involves a procedural application and participation governed by the relevant Rule, rather than automatic settlement of every complaint. The Rules describe mediation fees and a period associated with suspending complaint proceedings while mediation is pending. That period should not be confused with the Charter's one-hour filing-service estimate or with the initial review of a complaint. When a user asks whether mediation is available, the answer should identify the applicable process and leave decisions about eligibility, fee treatment and the substantive settlement to the competent authority and parties.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule VI, Sections 2-4; PDF page 14); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule VI, Sections 1-2; PDF page 14); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule VI, Sections 4 and 12; PDF pages 14-16)

39. Preliminary conference and potential mediation referral

The consolidated rules say that when alternative dispute resolution is availed of by the parties, the Investigating Officer may refer the matter to mediation under Rule VI. Mediation is not synonymous with completing the complaint-affidavit or sending a filing email. It is a procedural path described by the Rules, involving the parties and NPC officers, and should not be represented as automatic for every complaint.

Rule V describes a preliminary conference after the comment period, used to consider alternative dispute resolution, possible discovery, simplification of issues, agreement about facts or documents, and other matters supporting prompt case handling. This is a later procedural stage than filing. A RAG chatbot can outline its general purpose but should not schedule conferences, speak for an Investigating Officer, or provide case-specific tactics.

The preliminary conference is a procedural step distinct from filing at an intake counter. The amended Rules describe matters addressed during that stage and how mediation may be considered during proceedings. The chatbot can provide orientation about the existence and purpose of the preliminary conference and point to Rule V, but it cannot choose evidence, prepare litigation tactics or predict what a particular Investigating Officer will direct the parties to do. A useful response separates the official meeting procedure from the earlier administrative sequence of obtaining forms, lodging papers, payment assessment and receiving docket information.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule V, Section 2; PDF page 11); NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule V, Section 1; PDF page 11)

40. Mediated agreements and the scope of procedural resolution

In successful mediation, the parties or their authorized representatives jointly execute a mediated settlement agreement, after which the Rules contemplate confirmation procedures. The Mediation Officer supports the process, and the Commission has its own role. A generated chatbot message cannot create an official agreement or certify it. General informational answers should refer to the source and note that real settlements are decided by the participants and NPC.

The mediated settlement provisions address what follows if the parties actually reach an agreement through the prescribed process. The fact that mediation may be available does not mean an agreement is guaranteed. Nor should a chatbot claim that one party's proposal has legal effect merely because it was discussed in a conference. The

amended Rules address the submission and treatment of agreements through the Commission's process. This is useful process-level information for a user exploring NPC procedures, but drafting a binding settlement, deciding compliance, or determining enforcement consequences requires the appropriate legal and official procedures.

Source references: NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 (Rule VI, Sections 13-15; PDF pages 16-17)

Official source register

These are URLs for the original NPC webpages and PDF files used by the previous Version 6 source register. Source labels in the passage sections point to these resources. Official editions may change; check for updates before experimentation or deployment.

NPC-CC-2025 - NPC Citizen's Charter 2025 (1st Edition): Filing of

Complaints Process https://privacy.gov.ph/wp-

content/uploads/2025/05/NPC_CC-2025-1st-Edition.pdf

NPC-RULES-AMENDED-2024 - 2021 Rules of Procedure of the National Privacy

Commission, as Amended https://privacy.gov.ph/wp-

content/uploads/2024/03/2021-Rules-of-Procedure-of-the-NPC-As-Amended.pdf

NPC-CAF-2026 - NPC Complaint-Affidavit / Reklamong Salaysay,

NPC_LEO_CID_CAF-V2.0 https://privacy.gov.ph/wp-

content/uploads/2026/03/2026.03.01-CAF_Complaint-Affidavit-with-QA-1.pdf

NPC-FILING-WEB - NPC File a Complaint (English and Tagalog)

https://privacy.gov.ph/file-a-

complaint-2/ NPC-RIGHTS -

NPC Data Subject Rights

https://privacy.gov.ph/data-

subject-rights/ NPC-CONTACT-

LIVE - NPC Contact Us

https://privacy.gov.ph/contactus/

NPC-ANNOUNCE-2024 - NPC amends its 2021 Rules of Procedure

(announcement) https://privacy.gov.ph/npc-amends-its-2021-

rules-of-procedure/

Methodological note: This PDF is a preparation corpus, not an evaluation answer key. Any

benchmark should keep its questions, gold answers and unsupported cases separate. Fixed-size splitting will generate a different number of machine chunks depending on the PDF loader and the splitter settings; topic headings here are not chunk boundaries.